



ADDENDUM NO. 1

REQUEST FOR PROPOSALS
WEBSITE DESIGN, DEVELOPMENT, HOSTING, AND SUPPORT
SERVICES

CITY OF WEST CHICAGO, ILLINOIS

Issued: May 29, 2026

This Addendum forms a part of the Request for Proposals (RFP) for Website Design, Development, Hosting, and Support Services and shall be incorporated into the Proposal. The purpose of this Addendum is to provide responses and clarifications to questions received from prospective vendors.

Except as modified herein, all requirements of the original RFP remain unchanged.

Schedule Revision

Due to the level of interest in the project and the anticipated volume of proposals, the City is revising portions of the procurement schedule to allow sufficient time for proposal review and evaluation.

The following dates are revised:

Milestone	Original Date	Revised Date
Proposal Deadline	June 8, 2026 at 12:00pm	June 8, 2026 at 12:00pm (no change)
Completion of Proposal Evaluations/Vendor Notification	June 12, 2026	June 22, 2026
Interviews/Demos by Vendors	June 15, 2026 (two-hour time slots)*	June 29, 2026 to July 2, 2026
Vendor Selection	June 19, 2026	July 10, 2026
Contract Negotiation Completed	June 29, 2026	July 24, 2026
Finance Committee Meeting	July 6, 2026	August 3, 2026
Contract Approval by City Council	July 6, 2026	August 3, 2026
Project Kick-off	Mid-July	Mid-August

Questions have been consolidated by topic. Similar questions have been combined and addressed collectively where appropriate.

1. Project Goals, Priorities, and Success Measures

Question Summary

Several vendors requested clarification regarding the City's primary objectives, operational challenges, desired success metrics, user experience priorities, and overall vision for the website modernization effort.

Response

The City's priorities were established through a discovery process that included staff engagement, public engagement, and review by a cross-departmental working group.

The primary priorities identified for the project are:

1. Find Information (Navigation & Search)
2. Ease of Site Use (Mobile, Usability, Accessibility)
3. Easily Complete Processes (Forms, Payments, Processes)

Additional priorities include:

4. Clearly Identify Help (Contact & Routing)
5. Access Public Information (Meetings, Documents, Transparency)
6. Accurate & Timely Content

The City seeks measurable improvements in usability, accessibility, service completion, public information access, and content management. Vendors are encouraged to recommend metrics, analytics approaches, and ongoing optimization strategies that support these objectives.

2. Content Migration and Governance

Question Summary

Several vendors requested clarification regarding the amount of content to be migrated, content ownership, migration responsibilities, PDF conversion, and governance expectations.

Response

The City has not completed a final content inventory. A preliminary review identified 125 currently active (published) web pages, and 600 documents were uploaded to the website during 2025, such as agendas, minutes, and forms.

The City anticipates migrating approximately 75 pages and 700 documents to the new website. These documents include an estimated 490 agendas, minutes, and meeting packets beginning January 1, 2026, based on 2025 document counts.

The selected vendor will be expected to assist the City in developing a content inventory, migration strategy, and governance framework during implementation.

As stated in the RFP, the City anticipates migrating active content and approximately the past year of archived content to the new platform. Final migration decisions will be made collaboratively during implementation. Vendors should include a content inventory and migration planning process within their proposed approach.

The City anticipates participation from multiple departments in reviewing content, identifying outdated information, and determining migration priorities.

The reference to "content ownership" in the RFP relates to establishing accountability for content maintenance, updates, review cycles, publishing permissions, and long-term governance responsibilities.

Additional Clarification – PDF Content

The City recognizes that document accessibility and usability are important project considerations. Vendors are encouraged to recommend practical approaches for improving accessibility, searchability, and long-term management of document-based content, including strategies that may reduce reliance on PDFs over time.

3. Forms, Workflows, and Online Transactions

Question Summary

Several vendors requested clarification regarding modern digital forms, incomplete submissions, workflow automation, online payments, and priority service areas.

Response

The City is seeking solutions that improve the user experience associated with forms, applications, requests, and online transactions.

Examples may include:

- Mobile-friendly forms
- Conditional logic
- Validation rules
- Improved routing
- Workflow automation
- Reduced reliance on static PDFs
- Improved user feedback and confirmation mechanisms

The City's reference to reducing incomplete or incorrect submissions is intended to encourage solutions that improve form usability, data validation, routing accuracy, and overall service completion.

Priority Workflows

The City is implementing CloudPermit for building permit applications and related permitting functions. As a result, building permits are not anticipated to be a workflow within the scope of this project.

The City is interested in solutions that improve the user experience associated with forms, applications, requests, and online transactions that are managed directly through the website. Examples may include:

- Business registration and licensing
- Special event permits and applications
- Service requests and general inquiries
- Event registrations
- Other forms and processes that can be streamlined through the website platform

The City encourages vendors to identify opportunities to improve process completion, reduce manual handling, and enhance the overall customer experience while maintaining flexibility for future operational needs.

4. Accessibility and Multilingual Access

Question Summary

Several vendors requested clarification regarding accessibility standards, accessibility audits, multilingual support, and translation priorities.

Response

The City requires compliance with WCAG 2.1 AA standards at a minimum.

Vendors may propose solutions that align with WCAG 2.2 standards or future accessibility requirements. As accessibility standards, regulations, and best practices continue to evolve, vendors should describe their approach to maintaining accessibility compliance over time, including:

- How the platform and CMS support ongoing accessibility improvements
- Processes for monitoring accessibility issues and identifying remediation needs
- Responsibilities of the vendor and City staff in maintaining accessibility compliance
- How future platform updates, enhancements, and content changes are managed to support accessibility objectives
- Recommended tools, training, workflows, or services that help ensure continued compliance with evolving accessibility standards

The City is interested in solutions that provide a sustainable approach to accessibility rather than a one-time compliance effort.

Accessibility Testing and Review

The RFP references accessibility testing, ongoing monitoring, and an independent accessibility review prior to launch.

Vendors should describe:

- Their accessibility testing methodology throughout design, development, content migration, and quality assurance
- Tools and processes used to identify and remediate accessibility issues
- Experience coordinating with independent accessibility reviewers or auditors, if applicable
- Their approach to addressing accessibility deficiencies identified prior to launch

The City reserves the right to facilitate an independent third-party accessibility review prior to website launch. If such a review is conducted, the selected vendor will be expected to cooperate with the review process and address identified accessibility issues as part of project implementation.

Vendors may optionally identify the cost of an independent third-party accessibility review prior to launch, including scope, methodology, and remediation process.

Multilingual Access

The City is interested in improving multilingual access throughout the website, including navigation, content, forms, alerts, and public information.

Vendors should assume English and Spanish support as a minimum and may recommend additional multilingual strategies based on their experience and best practices.

Vendors should also describe how translated content is maintained over time, including any limitations associated with automated translation tools and recommended approaches for document-based content.

5. System Integrations and Technology Environment

Question Summary

Several vendors requested clarification regarding GIS integration, payment systems, future integrations, alerts, notifications, and municipal systems.

Response

The City currently utilizes:

- Illinois E-Pay
- DACRA
- ESRI GIS applications and web maps

The City currently utilizes Illinois E-Pay and DACRA for certain payment-related functions. At this time, the City has not independently evaluated the availability or capabilities of APIs associated with Illinois E-Pay or DACRA. Vendors should identify any assumptions regarding current payment integrations within their proposal.

The City is also evaluating enterprise resource planning (ERP) systems and anticipates that a future ERP system may include an integrated online payment solution. Implementation of a new ERP system is not anticipated as part of this website project and may occur in a future phase, potentially within the next two years.

Vendors should describe how their proposed website platform can support flexibility for future changes to payment systems, including the ability to link to, embed, or integrate with future third-party or ERP-based payment solutions.

The City has not established a preferred payment processing model at this time. Vendors should clearly identify any fees associated with their proposed solution and indicate whether such fees are typically borne by the municipality, the end user, or both.

The City has not selected future agenda management, notification, citizen portal, or alert systems at this time. Vendors should describe how their proposed platform supports both current and future integrations. The City is interested in solutions that provide flexibility and scalability as future needs evolve.

GIS Integration

The City is open to vendor recommendations regarding GIS implementation. Solutions may include embedded maps, integrated map experiences, external GIS applications, or a combination thereof.

6. Hosting, Security, Infrastructure, and .gov Transition

Question Summary

Several vendors requested clarification regarding hosting requirements, cybersecurity, FedRAMP requirements, data storage, insurance, and the .gov transition.

Response

The City has not specified a required hosting provider, geographic hosting region, or FedRAMP-certified environment.

Vendors should propose hosting, cybersecurity, backup, disaster recovery, and infrastructure solutions that reflect industry best practices and satisfy the requirements outlined in the RFP.

The City has secured a .gov domain and anticipates coordination with the selected vendor as part of implementation planning.

7. Organizational Structure, Governance, and Project Management

Question Summary

Several vendors requested clarification regarding internal approvals, governance, staffing participation, and decision-making authority.

Response

The project is being guided by a cross-departmental staff working group representing multiple City functions. The working group is responsible for proposal evaluation, project guidance, and implementation support. Final project decisions will be made through the City's established administrative and approval processes. The selected vendor should anticipate coordination with multiple departments throughout the project.

8. Procurement, Evaluation, Budget, and Interviews

Question Summary

Several vendors requested clarification regarding project budget, qualifying municipal experience, interview expectations, evaluation procedures, and project schedule.

Response

Budget

The City has budgeted \$85,000 for this project in Fiscal Year 2026, which is a calendar year. This project is anticipated to carry into 2027.

Vendors should propose solutions that best meet the requirements identified in the RFP and clearly distinguish between required services, optional services, and future enhancements.

Municipal Website Experience Requirement

Vendors shall demonstrate experience with comprehensive municipal website implementations for local government entities within the United States. Relevant experience should demonstrate familiarity with public sector requirements such as accessibility compliance, public information access, transparency, public meetings, online service delivery, and content governance.

Related municipal digital platforms, such as permitting portals, service request systems, payment portals, or other citizen-facing applications, may be considered as supplemental experience demonstrating relevant qualifications. However, such platforms may not independently satisfy the minimum requirement for municipal website implementation experience.

The City will evaluate vendor qualifications based on the overall breadth, relevance, and demonstrated success of comparable municipal projects.

Interviews and Demonstrations

The City anticipates conducting interviews and demonstrations with approximately three shortlisted vendors between June 29 and July 2, 2026. Shortlisted vendors are anticipated to be notified on or about June 22, 2026, following completion of the initial proposal evaluation process.

The entire proposed project team is not required to attend. However, attendees should include the individuals who will be primarily responsible for project management, implementation oversight, and demonstration of the proposed approach and solution.

Vendors should be prepared to discuss:

- Project approach
- Implementation methodology
- CMS usability
- Municipal experience
- Relevant project examples

The City is not requiring mockups or prototype designs as part of proposal submission.

Proposers should indicate their availability for interviews and demonstrations between June 29 and July 2, 2026, within their proposal. The City will make reasonable efforts to accommodate identified availability but reserves the right to establish the final interview schedule.

The City prefers in-person participation as identified in the RFP. However, limited remote participation by technical specialists or subject matter experts who are supporting the vendor's presentation may be considered at the City's discretion.

Addendum Acknowledgment

Proposers shall acknowledge receipt of all addenda issued by the City and include a completed Addendum Acknowledgment Form with their proposal. Failure to acknowledge issued addenda may result in the proposal being deemed non-responsive.

Contract and Insurance Requirements

The selected vendor will be required to enter into a professional services agreement with the City.

Vendors doing business with the City must be authorized to transact business in the State of Illinois and must comply with all applicable federal, state, and local laws and regulations.

Insurance requirements applicable to the selected vendor will be addressed as part of contract negotiations and execution. The City of West Chicago is a member of the Illinois Municipal League Risk Management Association (RMA). Insurance requirements applicable to the selected vendor will be established in accordance with the City's contractual requirements and applicable municipal risk management practices.

Additional insurance requirements may be imposed based on the final scope of services, including hosting, cybersecurity, data management, or other services associated with the selected solution.

Proof of required insurance coverage will be required prior to execution of an agreement with the City.

Project Timeline

The anticipated Q1 2027 launch date remains a target project milestone. Vendors should identify any schedule assumptions, risks, or recommendations within their proposal.

ADDENDUM ACKNOWLEDGMENT

Website Design, Development, Hosting, and Support Services City of West Chicago

The undersigned acknowledges receipt of the following addenda issued by the City of West Chicago related to the Request for Proposals for Website Design, Development, Hosting, and Support Services.

☐ Addendum No. 1 dated May 29, 2026

The proposer acknowledges that the requirements, clarifications, and modifications contained within the addenda have been incorporated into its proposal.

Firm Name: _____

Authorized Representative: _____

Title: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____